this, so they were getting really excited at the prospect of sharing in some serious money.

The Proteas squad works as follows in terms of individual prize money: if, for example, you are Man of the Match, you get half the prize money and the team splits the rest. The ous were understandably amped – US$500 000 split among them would be a tidy and unexpected little bonus. Obviously most of the people I'd ever met must have known this too, because when I looked at my cellphone later, I had received tons more messages than I usually do when I've played well. If I get a century or something big, I probably receive about 80 or 90 congratulatory SMSes … that day I got 130. Clearly they all thought I'd hit the jackpot.

Unfortunately not, as it turned out …

The prize money was actually supposed to be allocated to a charity of my choice and would not be given to me personally. I won't lie and say that I wasn't a little disappointed. I mean, in what other international sport do you not get a financial reward for setting a world record? Be that as it may, I am proud of the fact that I was able to donate a million to the Habitat for Humanity foundation, which provides homes for underprivileged people. Some of the money went to people in Trinidad and the rest to people in Johannesburg. All in all, the cash prize meant that over a thousand people benefited from my six sixes.

The same deal applied to Matthew Hayden, who got a 100 off 66 balls – the quickest 100 in World Cup history. We were both also awarded honorary citizenship of St Kitts and Nevis, which I would put to good use, getting married on the island later that year. Apparently this citizenship is worth in the region of US$300 000, so I guess I did get some reward!

The 438 game

As you will have gathered from Chapter 4, with the amount of alcohol I had consumed the previous night, I should not even have been on the field for the start of this momentous game on the morning of 12 March 2006. This was a massive game for the team. After winning the initial two ODIs easily, the Aussies – predictably – had come back at us, winning the next two, so we had everything to play for in the decider.

Remember that this was on the back of a very disappointing tour Down Under, where we'd failed to reach the final of the triangular ODI tournament against the Aussies and Sri Lanka (we had lost three of our four